

Gold Forum Retreat: Facilitator Guide

May 6-8, 2026 | Cabo San Lucas

Goal: Build comfort, trust, and connection. The foundation for deeper future work.

Retreat at a Glance

Day	Date	Focus
Day 1	Wed, May 6	Arrival + Story Behind the Story (evening)
Day 2	Thu, May 7	Full day: Living Backward, Formation Audit, Proudest + Hardest
Day 3	Fri, May 8	Appreciations + Future Snapshot + Depart

Pre-work sent ahead: David Gibson podcast (58 min) + Formation Audit (60 min private quiet time).

Thursday, May 7: Full Day Schedule

Time	Session	Duration
Morning	Living Backward Discussion (Gibson debrief)	75-90 min
Midday	Shared activity / lunch / white space	(open)
Afternoon	Formation Audit: quiet work block	30 min
Afternoon	Formation Audit: Shared Reflection	90-120 min
Evening	Proudest + Hardest	90-120 min
Evening	Relaxed social time	(open)

Thursday Session Guide

Morning: Living Backward Discussion

Pre-req: Gibson podcast (pre-listen). **Time:** 75-90 min.

Open group conversation anchored in the podcast. Let it breathe. Don't rush to resolution. The discomfort is the point.

Suggested prompts:

- What in the Gibson episode hit you hardest, and why?
- Where in your life are you living forward (chasing, acquiring, performing) when the end of life would tell you it doesn't matter as much as you think?
- What would you do differently if you knew you had 5 years left? What's stopping you from doing that now?
- Where do you feel most out of control, and is that actually a gift?

Facilitator notes:

- The podcast does the heavy lifting. You're just responding to it together.
- Resist the urge to solve or resolve. Let answers hang in the room.
- If energy stalls, go back to the simplest question: What landed?

Afternoon: Formation Audit

Pre-req: Individual pre-work completed. **Time:** 30 min quiet block + 90-120 min shared reflection.

Start with 30 minutes of quiet. Let anyone who didn't finish pre-work complete it now. Then move to shared reflection.

Suggested structure per person (8-12 min):

- One habit or relationship that is forming them well
- One area (story, environment, or experience) where they feel most deformed or stuck
- One thing they want to change, and what's in the way

The five formation areas to draw from:

- Habits: morning, workday, evening, weekend routines
- Relationships: who draws out the best in you? Who suppresses it?
- Stories You Believe: about God, yourself, success, meaning
- Environment: digital, social, economic, generational forces shaping 'normal'
- Experience: family of origin, trauma, key moments, spiritual autobiography

Facilitator notes:

- Recommit to confidentiality before starting: "Nothing. Nobody. Never."
- Not everything needs to be shared. Members choose what to bring.
- Watch for anyone who goes intellectual instead of personal. Gently redirect.
- 8-12 min per person keeps energy up. Enforce it kindly.

Evening: Proudest + Hardest

Time: 90-120 min.

Each person shares one thing they are most proud of (and why it matters) and one thing that was hardest (feelings, not just facts) from the last 12 months.

Facilitator notes:

- Steer away from purely business updates. This is about the person, not the portfolio.
- "Hardest" means feelings. If someone gives you a situation, ask: What did that feel like?
- Let silence do its work after each share. Don't rush to the next person.
- If the group is energized, this can run long. That's fine. Don't cut it short.

Guardrails

- Don't overpack the schedule. White space is not wasted time.
- No alcohol during Forum sessions.
- Equal airtime. Watch for anyone going long or going quiet. Draw out the quiet ones.
- Recommit to confidentiality before the Formation Audit: "Nothing. Nobody. Never."

- End sessions while energy is still high. Better to leave them wanting more.
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Core Principle

The goal is not maximum depth. The goal is building trust, comfort, and connection so deeper work comes naturally in future retreats. The Formation Audit and Gibson podcast will take people deeper than they expect, which is fine. The guardrails and pacing exist to make sure depth lands as growth, not overwhelm.